QPCODE: 25900998

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR /IMPROVEMENT / REAPPEARANCE

EXAMINATION NOVEMBER 2025

First Semester

Multi Disciplinary Courses (MDC) – MG1MDCTTM101 –ECO TOURISM

Duration: 1 Hour **Max.Marks:35**

Part A

Short Answer Questions, Answer any 5 Questions, Each Question carries 2 marks

1. Name any two ecotourism activities in a desert. [U] [CO1]
Camel Safaris , Desert Camping , Bird Watching , Nature Photography ,Sand boarding , Stargazing , Eco-guided Walks etc…

2. Name the traditional boat race of Kerala [U] / [CO2]
Vallam Kali (Snake Boat Racecalled **"ChundanVallams"**)

3. Examine the need of eco tourism planning. [An] / [CO4]
Ecotourism planning is essential to ensure sustainable use of natural resources, protect fragile ecosystems, and reduce negative impacts on biodiversity. It promotes community participation, supports local livelihoods, and enhances visitor experiences

4. Select any two Mangrove forests in Kerala. [K] / [CO1]
Kadalundi Mangrove Forest **,** Kannur Mangrove Forest ,Vypeen–Muziris Mangrove Belt**,** Ashtamudi Lake Mangrove Forest etc…

5. Explain any two key considerations while planning an eco-tourism destination. [U] /[CO2]
Environmental Sustainability, Community Participation, Conservation of Biodiversity, Infrastructure Development etc….

6. Identify any two eco tourism destinations in Kerala [K] / [CO1]
Thenmala Ecotourism**,** Gavi Ecotourism**,** Periyar Tiger Reserve ,Wayanad Wildlife Sanctuaryetc..

7. Identify the protected species in Manas National park. [K] / [CO1]
Indian One-Horned Rhinoceros**,** Royal Bengal Tiger**,** Asian Elephant**,** Pygmy Hog**,** Golden Langur**,** Assam Roofed Turtle,hispid hare, and swamp deer. etc…

8. Interpret any two wildlife conservation projects in India. [U] / [CO2]
Project Tiger, Project Elephant, Crocodile Conservation Project, Project Snow Leopard etc..

Part B

Short Essay Questions, Answer any 2 Questions, Each Question carries 5 marks

9. Explain the factors that have contributed to the success of eco-tourismdestinations in Kerala. **[An] / [CO3]**

Kerala's ecotourism success is driven by rich biodiversity, strong government initiatives, active community participation, Eco-friendly infrastructure, effective conservation practices, responsible tourism policies, sustainable development, cultural heritage, educational programs, protected natural landscapes,visitor experiences etc…..

10. Identify the sustainable practices that can be implemented at an ecotourism destination. **[U] / [CO4]**

Proper waste management, water and energy conservation, use of eco-friendly infrastructure, protecting wildlife, limiting visitor numbers, supporting local communities, educating tourists, promoting responsible use of natural resources etc…

11. Discuss Natural carrying capacity. **[U] / [CO4]**

Natural carrying capacity refers to the maximum number of visitors an environment can support without causing ecological damage.

12. Classify the different types of eco-tourists, and briefly describe the characteristics of any two. **[U] / [CO1]**

1. **Adventure Eco-tourists** – Engage in physically challenging outdoor activities.
2. **Wildlife Eco-tourists** – Focus on observing animals and birds in their natural habitats.
3. **Cultural Eco-tourists** – Interested in local traditions, crafts, and indigenous lifestyles.
4. **Educational Eco-tourists** – Travel to learn about ecosystems, biodiversity, and conservation.
5. **Volunteer Eco -tourists** – Participate in conservation or community development projects.
6. **Recreational Eco-tourists**–Enjoy eco-friendly leisure activities like camping or nature photography.

Part C

Long Essay Questions, Answer any 1 Question, Each Question carries 15 marks

13.Compare the ecological importance of rivers, seas, and lakes. Discuss how eco-tourists can engage in sustainable activities in these environments while conserving the flora and fauna. **[U] / [CO1]**

Rivers support freshwater biodiversity, transport nutrients, recharge groundwater, and sustain forests, wetlands, and agriculture.

Seas regulate global climate, store carbon, support marine life, and maintain the world's largest ecosystems such as coral reefs.

Lakes act as freshwater reservoirs, support aquatic species, balance local climates, and provide habitats for birds and fish.

Eco-tourists can engage sustainably by avoiding pollution, minimizing waste, and using non-motorised activities,follow marked trails, respect wildlife distances, avoid disturbing habitats,supporting local conservation programs, choosing eco-friendly accommodations, learning about local ecosystems

14. Describe the role of National Parks in balancing conservation and tourism with suitable examples ? [U] / [CO2]

Protecting ecosystems ,controlled visitor access, preserve wildlife, maintain natural habitats, and support scientific research, promote eco-friendly tourism activities like safaris, guided trails, and interpretation centres etc…

For example, Periyar National Park in Kerala protects tigers and elephants while offering guided boat safaris. Kaziranga National Park conserves the one-horned rhinoceros and manages tourism through restricted jeep etc….

15. Examine the various alternative tourism with appropriate examples. [A] /[CO4]

Alternative tourism refers to forms of travel that differ from conventional mass tourism. It focuses on sustainable, authentic, and environmentally or culturally sensitive experiences, often promoting local development and minimizing negative impacts.

- Ecotourism. Eg: Gavi Ecotourism in Kerala, Periyar Tiger Reserve.
- Adventure Tourism. Eg: River rafting in Rishikesh, trekking in Himachal Pradesh.
- Cultural Tourism. Eg: Visiting forts and palaces in Rajasthan, attending Theyyamperformances
- Rural Tourism. Eg: Kumbalangi Model Village in Kerala.
- Wildlife Tourism. Eg: Safari tours in Kaziranga National Park or Bandipur Tiger Reserve.
- Medical Tourism. Eg: Kerala's Ayurveda treatments; medical hospitals attracting international patients to Chennai etc...